

6 280100 003330

WEDNESDAY
FEBRUARY 18, 2026
RAMADAN 1, 1447



RAMADAN
UPDATES

Dominic & Partners

Partner for a better tomorrow.
Audit | Tax | Advisory

Branches: Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah, RAK and Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
Suite B 3001, Latifa tower, Sheikh Zayed Road, Dubai
info@domuae.com | www.domuae.com | Dubai +971 56 6040 648 | +971 50 9801 263

3545758.11

UAE leaders extend Ramadan greetings

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Leaders of the UAE have extended their congratulations to citizens and residents as well as Muslims around the world as Ramadan begins today. President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan said: "With the arrival of the holy month of Ramadan, I extend my sincere best wishes to the people of the UAE and across the world. Ramadan is a time for reflection and generosity, and an opportunity to strengthen bonds within families and communities."

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said: "We extend our warmest wishes to the people of the UAE and to all Arab and Muslim communities on the occasion of the holy month of Ramadan. A blessed season of generosity, compassion, family connection and spiritual reflection. May Allah bring it back to us and to you in peace, security and good health, and accept our good deeds and yours."



IFTAR 18:18
Fajr 05:34 Shuruq 06:48
Dhuhr 12:36 Asr 15:50
Maghrib 18:18 Isha 19:32

ISRAK 05:24
Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

UAE ramps up Ramadan price checks to shield households

DAILY INSPECTIONS TO PREVENT PRICE MANIPULATION OF ESSENTIAL GOODS

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

The UAE has once again put the interest of consumers first by warning retailers against price increases for nine categories of essential goods during Ramadan, while inspection teams in Dubai have already begun field visits ahead of the fasting month to ensure price labels match checkout bills and that supply levels remain stable.

Authorities said the early inspections reflect a nationwide push to shield households from seasonal price pressures during a period when grocery spending typically rises sharply. The Dubai Corporation for Consumer Protection and Fair Trade confirmed that inspection campaigns are underway across supermarkets, cooperatives and neighbourhood grocery outlets, focusing on verifying shelf prices, monitoring promotions and ensuring no retailer raises prices without prior approval.

9 essential items

The policy covers cooking oil, eggs, dairy products, rice, sugar, poultry, legumes, bread and wheat. Any attempt to increase prices on these items without approval triggers immediate enforcement action. Ahmad Ahli, Acting Director of Consumer Protection at the Dubai Corporation for Consumer Protection and Fair Trade, said inspection teams conduct routine visits to ensure transparency.

"We do conduct regular visits to make sure that the prices are stable and the promotions are



Ramadan cannon tradition returns as Dubai Police prepare emirate-wide firing sites. Dubai Police have announced 33 Ramadan iftar cannon locations across the emirate.

REPORT PRICE MANIPULATION

Consumers who suspect price manipulation or unfair practices are encouraged to report them promptly through official channels. Authorities said shoppers should retain receipts and any quotations or purchase records to support their complaint. Reports can be submitted via the consumer protection hotline at 600-545-555 or through the UAE's online consumer rights portal, where cases are reviewed and investigated to ensure swift resolution.

— N. D.

actual and to make sure that the prices on the shelves are the actual price that the consumer will pay at the cash counter," he told *Gulf News* during an inspection visit. Inspectors select random

products, check shelf labels and scan them at checkout systems to confirm consistency.

Regulators said enforcement action begins immediately when violations are detected. "If

there's a price increase in any of the essential products, then we immediately seize the sales of that product until the price is adjusted within the approved range," Ahli said. Fines can range from Dh500 to Dh100,000, and repeated violations may lead to temporary closure.

Authorities clarified that price differences between retailers remain legal, but any mismatch between shelf and checkout prices is treated as a serious offence. Officials also monitor stock levels to prevent artificial shortages.

SEE ALSO P3

NATION

Traffic congestion:
RTA's bold plans to keep Dubai moving | P2

MIDDLE EAST

Iran shuts Strait of Hormuz for few hours over naval drills | P6



FINANCE

How UAE travellers are adjusting to visa delays and rising costs | P-III

Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00 Bahrain: BD 0.500 Oman: RO 0.500 India: Rs 40.00 S.Arabia: SR 5.00 Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Historic first day of CBSE exams

Maths paper posed no major surprises for Class 10 students

DUBAI

BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

The first day of CBSE exams 2026 marked a historic moment as students entered exam halls for the first time under the newly reformed structure, including the two-board exams for Class 10 and updated paper patterns.

Students across the UAE appeared for the Grade 10 maths board exam yesterday, while Class 12 students sat for minor subject papers.



Early reactions collected by *Gulf News* indicate the maths paper posed no major surprises, with well-prepared students answering confidently and completing it on time.

From early morning, school corridors buzzed with nervous energy and quiet determination. Students carried their transparent pouches and hall tickets, but also the weight of expectations and the hope

that months of preparation would meet the new exam format head-on.

All hands on deck

Teachers, having familiarised themselves with revised patterns, competency-based questions and stricter sectional rules, watched their students with a mix of pride and concern. Principals ensured the smooth conduct of exams, overseeing every detail — from attendance checks to seating arrangements.

Parents played a crucial role too, balancing reassurance with encouragement, helping their children approach this first exam with confidence rather than anxiety.

SEE ALSO P8-9

SPORT

Australia knocked out of T20 World Cup as Zimbabwe make Super 8

Zimbabwe qualify after Ireland match is washed out | P12



DON'T TURN THE PAGE
you might not like your current workspace anymore

**DESIGNED TO SEPARATE
BUILT TO CONNECT**

OFFICIAL STOCKIST AND INSTALLATION PARTNER
TIMBERGLOSS IND LLC, DIP 2, DUBAI, UAE

+971 52 197 5349
sales@timbergloss.com